

United States History and Geography — Teacher Key

United States History and Geography · Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28 · Form US-CORE-B

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classroom-formative · pre-field-test. Item parameters are estimates and have not met a student; this form is not a calibrated instrument. This is a selected-response form. It assesses Depth of Knowledge levels 1 through 3. It carries no extended-response item, so it does not assess DOK-4 — a four-option question cannot ask a student to construct and defend an argument. Extended responses and document-based questions are delivered as separate activities.

1. Why did critics of the New Deal charge that FDR's programs represented socialism?

- A. Because the New Deal greatly expanded federal regulation of the economy and created public employment and Social Security
- B. Because New Deal programs abolished all private and religious charities in favor of state services
- C. Because FDR eliminated private property rights by redistributing land from wealthy Americans to the poor
- D. Because FDR called for nationalizing all major American industries and placing them under government ownership

KEY: A · DOK 2 · US.46

Why the key is right: New Deal opponents — including business leaders and conservatives — argued that programs like the TVA (a government-owned utility), the AAA (government interference in markets), and Social Security (a government welfare program) crossed the line from capitalism into socialism by making the government a major economic actor.

B — Private and religious charities continued throughout the 1930s; federal relief supplemented them because their resources had been exhausted.

C — Private property rights were not abolished; New Deal farm policy paid owners to limit production rather than redistributing their land.

D — FDR never proposed nationalising major industries. The charge rested on regulation and public employment, not government ownership.

Item analysis

Standard

US.46 — Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt’s “court packing” attempt.

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must connect features of New Deal programs to the political charge made against them, which is a cause-and-claim relationship — DOK-2. Recalling that critics used the word 'socialism' would be DOK-1.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.3 · b 0.4 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

B — assumes federal relief replaced private charity; **C** — confuses regulation and subsidy with land redistribution; **D** — overstates the charge as nationalisation of industry

2. Critics of the New Deal from the left, including Huey Long and socialist intellectuals, argued it preserved capitalism without genuine structural transformation, while critics from the right argued it represented dangerous federal overreach. What does the existence of this two-sided criticism most reveal about the New Deal's actual ideological character and historical significance?

A. Roosevelt's political genius lay in synthesizing elements of both left and right criticism into a coherent program, borrowing regulatory ideas from progressives and efficiency principles from business conservatives to create pragmatic policies that maintained political viability by satisfying neither extreme.

B. The New Deal occupied a reform-without-revolution position — it stabilized the capitalist system by addressing its most destabilizing failures without fundamentally redistributing wealth or restructuring ownership — making it an ideologically moderate but historically unprecedented response to economic catastrophe that satisfied neither ideological extreme.

C. The two-sided criticism demonstrates that the New Deal was an incoherent collection of experimental programs lacking a unifying reform philosophy, which is why historians continue to debate whether it extended or shortened the Depression's duration rather than agreeing on a definitive assessment.

D. The New Deal's primary significance was its expansion of the permanent federal bureaucratic apparatus and the precedent it established for government economic intervention, regardless of whether its specific programs effectively accelerated economic recovery from the Depression.

KEY: B · DOK 3 · US.46

Why the key is right: The fact that Long attacked the New Deal for not going far enough while business conservatives attacked it for going too far locates it precisely in the ideologically moderate reform space: it used federal power to manage capitalism's most destructive tendencies without threatening the fundamental structures of private ownership and profit that left critics demanded be dismantled. Unit 5: Great Depression & New Deal, 1929–1941 (US.39–US.44)

Item analysis

Standard

US.46 — Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt's "court packing" attempt.

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.2 · b 1 · c 0.25 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

3. The Truman Doctrine established what new direction for U.S. foreign policy?

- A. Recognition of the Soviet Union as an ally
- B. A return to isolationism after World War II
- C. A commitment to support nations resisting communist expansion
- D. Withdrawal from the United Nations

KEY: C · DOK 2 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Truman Doctrine, articulated in President Truman's March 12, 1947, address to Congress requesting \$400 million in aid for Greece and Turkey, established U.S. commitment to support nations resisting communist expansion. The doctrine reframed U.S. foreign policy from regional intervention to a global containment strategy and provided the rationale for subsequent Cold War commitments including the Marshall Plan, NATO, and Korean War involvement. Choice B is wrong because the doctrine explicitly rejected isolationism. Choice A is wrong because Truman cast the Soviet Union as the principal adversary the doctrine was designed to counter. Choice D is wrong because the United States was a founding member and host of the United Nations.

A — The Soviet Union had been a wartime ally, and the doctrine marks the point at which that relationship was publicly abandoned.

B — The doctrine did the reverse: it committed the United States to peacetime intervention abroad and ended the interwar isolationist position.

D — The United States remained in the United Nations and used it during the Cold War, including in Korea.

Item analysis

Standard

US.60 — Analyze the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must characterise a shift in policy direction rather than recall the doctrine's name — connecting a specific commitment to a broader change, which is DOK-2.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.0 · b 0.0 · c 0.25 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

A — keeps the wartime alliance the doctrine was written to end; **B** — reverses the direction of the postwar policy shift; **D** — invents a withdrawal that did not happen

4. Which best explains why the Truman Doctrine of 1947 represented a significant departure from traditional American foreign policy?

- A. It established the United Nations as the primary institution through which the United States would respond to Soviet expansion.
- B. It replaced the Monroe Doctrine by formally extending American security commitments from the Western Hemisphere to the entire world.
- C. It authorized the United States military to conduct offensive operations against Soviet-backed governments in Eastern Europe.
- D. It committed the United States to supporting free peoples resisting subjugation by outside pressures, abandoning the prewar tradition of non-intervention in foreign conflicts.

KEY: D · DOK 3 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Truman Doctrine's commitment to assist any nation resisting communist pressure formalized the break from the pre-WWII tradition of non-intervention and set the strategic framework — containment — that defined American foreign policy for the Cold War.

Item analysis

Standard

US.60 — Analyze the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.2 · b 1.0 · c 0.25 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

5. What did the Brown v. Board of Education decision accomplish?

- A. Declared school segregation unconstitutional and overturned Plessy
- B. The separate but equal doctrine established in Plessy v. Ferguson
- C. Plessy v. Ferguson (1896), which established "separate but equal"
- D. Being too vague and allowing Southern states to delay integration

KEY: A · DOK 1 · US.74

Why the key is right: Brown v. Board of Education ruled in 1954 that segregated public schools violated the Equal Protection Clause because separate schools were inherently unequal. D is wrong because it points to a different issue, while Brown focused on public education and overturned legal school segregation. The decision became the legal foundation for later civil rights challenges to Jim Crow.

Item analysis

Standard

US.74 — Examine the decision and impacts of Brown v. Board of Education on the desegregation of schools, such as Scarboro 85, Clinton 12 and Little Rock 9. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 0.87 · b 0.05 · c 0.22 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

6. Which argument did the NAACP's legal team most effectively use to persuade the Supreme Court to rule in *Brown v. Board of Education*?

- A. The Fifteenth Amendment guaranteed African Americans the right to attend any public institution regardless of race
- B. Segregated schools violated the Fourteenth Amendment's equal protection clause because separate facilities produced unequal educational and psychological outcomes
- C. Segregation was economically inefficient because maintaining duplicate school systems wasted public tax revenue
- D. The federal government had a constitutional obligation to fund integrated schools under the commerce clause

KEY: B · DOK 2 · US.74

Why the key is right: Thurgood Marshall and the NAACP argued that segregation violated the Equal Protection Clause of the Fourteenth Amendment, supported by Kenneth Clark's doll studies showing psychological harm to Black children in segregated schools.

Item analysis

Standard

US.74 — Examine the decision and impacts of *Brown v. Board of Education* on the desegregation of schools, such as *Scarboro 85*, *Clinton 12* and *Little Rock 9*. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.2 · b 0.1 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

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Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

7. Who was the chief counsel for the NAACP who argued *Brown v. Board* before the Supreme Court?

- A. Earl Warren, who served as Chief Justice of the Supreme Court
- B. A. Philip Randolph, who was a prominent labor and civil rights leader
- C. Thurgood Marshall, who led the NAACP Legal Defense Fund team
- D. Robert F. Kennedy, who served as Attorney General under JFK

KEY: C · DOK 1 · US.74, US.76

Why the key is right: Thurgood Marshall led the NAACP Legal Defense Fund team and argued *Brown v. Board* before the Supreme Court in 1954. A is wrong because Earl Warren was the chief justice who announced the Court's ruling, not the NAACP lawyer presenting the case. Marshall's courtroom victories helped turn the civil rights struggle into a national constitutional issue.

Item analysis

Standard

US.74 — Examine the decision and impacts of *Brown v. Board of Education* on the desegregation of schools, such as *Scarboro 85*, *Clinton 12* and *Little Rock 9*. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

Standard

US.76 — Examine the roles and actions of civil rights advocates (e.g., Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., Malcolm X, John Lewis, Diane Nash, Thurgood Marshall, Rosa Parks) and opponents (e.g., Bull Connor, Orval Faubus, George Wallace, Strom Thurmond). (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.18 · b -0.7 · c 0.25 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

8. Why did Rosa Parks' arrest in Montgomery, Alabama in 1955 become a catalyst for the civil rights movement rather than just another isolated incident of racial injustice?

- A. Parks was the first African American woman to be arrested for violating bus segregation laws in Alabama
- B. Parks' arrest immediately prompted President Eisenhower to send federal troops to Montgomery to enforce desegregation
- C. The Montgomery bus company publicly apologized for Parks' arrest, sparking a broader national debate about segregation laws
- D. Parks was a trained civil rights activist and NAACP secretary whose arrest was seen as a strategic moment to launch an organized community boycott

KEY: D · DOK 2 · US.76

Why the key is right: Parks was secretary of the Montgomery NAACP and had attended the Highlander Folk School. Civil rights leaders including E.D. Nixon recognized her arrest as the right moment to activate a prepared community boycott infrastructure.

Item analysis

Standard

US.76 — Examine the roles and actions of civil rights advocates (e.g., Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., Malcolm X, John Lewis, Diane Nash, Thurgood Marshall, Rosa Parks) and opponents (e.g., Bull Connor, Orval Faubus, George Wallace, Strom Thurmond). (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.4 · b 0.2 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

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Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

9. Title II of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 prohibited discrimination on the basis of race, color, religion, or national origin in which of the following?

- A. Public accommodations including hotels, restaurants, and theaters
- B. Federal income tax assessments and IRS audit procedures
- C. Housing transactions and real estate sales
- D. Voter registration in federal elections only

KEY: A · DOK 2 · US.78

Why the key is right: Title II of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 (Pub. L. 88-352, 78 Stat. 241) prohibits discrimination on the basis of race, color, religion, or national origin in 'places of public accommodation' — defined to include hotels, restaurants, theaters, and similar establishments engaged in interstate commerce. Title VII covers employment; the Fair Housing Act of 1968 covers housing; voting rights are covered by Title I (and later by the Voting Rights Act of 1965). Source: 42 U.S.C. §§ 2000a et seq.

Item analysis

Standard

US.78 — Analyze civil and voting rights legislation, including the Civil Rights Act of 1964, the Voting Rights Act of 1965, the Civil Rights Act of 1968 (i.e., Fair Housing Act), and the 24th Amendment. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

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Format

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Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

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10. Which best explains the significance of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 in the broader history of federal civil rights enforcement?

- A.** It granted federal courts the authority to automatically overturn any state law the executive branch identified as racially discriminatory.
- B.** It established federal enforcement mechanisms for prohibiting racial discrimination in public accommodations, employment, and federally funded programs.
- C.** It was the first federal law to prohibit racial discrimination in any domain of American life, replacing the ineffective Reconstruction-era civil rights acts.
- D.** It permanently resolved the constitutional question of whether the federal government could regulate private discrimination using the commerce clause.

KEY: B · DOK 3 · US.78

Why the key is right: Title II (public accommodations), Title VI (federally funded programs), and Title VII (employment), backed by enforcement through the Department of Justice and the new Equal Employment Opportunity Commission, gave the federal government its most robust civil rights enforcement tools to date.

Item analysis

Standard

US.78 — Analyze civil and voting rights legislation, including the Civil Rights Act of 1964, the Voting Rights Act of 1965, the Civil Rights Act of 1968 (i.e., Fair Housing Act), and the 24th Amendment. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

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Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

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